

Phish Gets Ready for Its 100th Show at Madison Square Garden

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The rock band Phish is about to reach a big **milestone**. On January 2, the band will play its 100th concert at Madison Square Garden, the famous **arena** in New York City. That show will wrap up a four-night run of concerts there around New Year's Eve.

Phish first played at the Garden on December 30, 1994. Over the past 32 years, the band has returned again and again for single shows and longer runs called **residencies**. In 2017, Phish played 13 shows there in a run called the Baker's Dozen. A baker's dozen means 13, one more than a regular dozen. During those shows, the band played 237 songs without repeating a single one.

To celebrate reaching 100 shows, Phish put together a video featuring people who have worked at the **arena** during its concerts over the years. **Ushers**, bartenders, food sellers and **merchandise** sellers shared their thoughts. "I love the Phish," one worker says. Another says Phish fans are the only fans who ask how everybody is treating you. The video also shows the relaxed, swaying way Phish fans like to dance.

Tickets for the four New York shows go on sale to the general public at noon on October 16. Ticketmaster is already taking ticket requests.

Before the New York shows, Phish has concerts scheduled this month in Virginia, Florida and Alabama. After the New York run, the band will **headline** its own festival, Phish: Riviera Maya 2027, in Cancún, Mexico, in late January. The festival will include eight sets from the band, DJ sets from James Murphy and Questlove, and comedy from Fred Armisen and other comedians.

Word Treasure

milestone -- An important event that marks progress, like a big number reached.

arena -- A large building with seats around a space for concerts or sports.

residencies -- Series of shows a performer plays at the same place over a period of time.

Ushers -- Workers who help people find their seats at an event.

merchandise -- Things for sale, such as T-shirts and posters with a band's name.

headline -- To be the main performer at a concert or festival.

Background you need

Madison Square Garden is a famous indoor arena in New York City that hosts concerts and sports games.

Phish is a rock band known for long live shows and for changing its song list from night to night, so many fans attend several concerts in a row.

When a performer plays a series of shows at one venue, it is called a residency.

Reaching 100 shows at one place is rare, because big arenas host many different performers.

Break it down

LEAD: Phish will play its 100th concert at Madison Square Garden on January 2

KEY EVENT: A four-night run around New Year's Eve ends with the milestone show

HISTORY: First Garden show on December 30, 1994; the 13-show Baker's Dozen in 2017 with 237 songs, none repeated

CELEBRATION: A video of ushers, bartenders and sellers sharing memories

+ - **TICKETS:** Public sale starts at noon on October 16

WHAT NEXT: Concerts in Virginia, Florida and Alabama, then a festival in Cancún, Mexico

Why it matters

Playing 100 shows at one arena shows how a band can build a loyal community over decades. The video also highlights the workers who help make concerts happen.

Test what you remember

1. On what date will Phish play its 100th show at Madison Square Garden?
 - (A) New Year's Eve
 - (B) October 16
 - (C) January 2
 - (D) December 30
2. When did Phish first play at the Garden?
 - (A) October 16, 1994
 - (B) December 30, 1994
 - (C) January 2, 2017
 - (D) December 31, 2000
3. What was the Baker's Dozen?
 - (A) A festival in Mexico
 - (B) A bakery near the arena
 - (C) A run of 13 shows in 2017
 - (D) A 12-song album
4. How many songs did Phish play during the Baker's Dozen without repeating one?
 - (A) 100
 - (B) 13
 - (C) 237
 - (D) 32
5. Who appears in the band's celebration video?
 - (A) Famous movie stars
 - (B) Only the band members
 - (C) Arena workers such as ushers and bartenders
 - (D) Basketball players
6. Where will Phish headline its own festival?
 - (A) Huntsville, Alabama
 - (B) Cancún, Mexico
 - (C) Richmond, Virginia
 - (D) Paris, France

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: C 4: C 5: C 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Arena workers: Say they love the band and that Phish fans are the only fans who ask how everybody is treating them.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):